

The 30-Point Pre-Training Checklist

Run through it before every workshop. Most delivery problems are logistics problems you could have caught the day before.

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One week before

- ☐ Objectives agreed with the organiser, in writing
- ☐ Participant list: number, age range, languages, needs
- ☐ Needs analysis done (what they know, what must change)
- ☐ Session plan timed block by block, with buffer
- ☐ Pre-assessment ready (3-5 questions or a quick poll)
- ☐ Venue confirmed: room size, layout, access, Wi-Fi
- ☐ Accessibility checked (stairs, seating, hearing, prayer times)
- ☐ Co-facilitator roles split and rehearsed

Two days before

- ☐ Slides final, exported to PDF as a backup
- ☐ Handouts printed (+10% spares)
- ☐ Materials packed: markers, flipchart, sticky notes, tape
- ☐ Energizers chosen for each low-energy moment
- ☐ Plan B for each activity if time runs short
- ☐ Reminder message sent to participants (time, place, what to bring)

On the day, before people arrive

- ☐ Arrive 45 minutes early
- ☐ Room set in the layout the activities need (circle, islands, U)
- ☐ Projector, sound, clicker and extension cable tested
- ☐ Wi-Fi and any online tool (poll, form) tested on a phone
- ☐ Agenda and objectives visible on a flipchart
- ☐ Attendance sheet and name tags ready
- ☐ Water, coffee break and lunch timings confirmed
- ☐ Phone on silent, timer ready

During the session

- ☐ Group agreements set in the first 15 minutes
- ☐ Language check: who is more comfortable in Arabic, French, English?
- ☐ Energy check every 45-60 minutes
- ☐ Parking lot for off-topic questions

Right after

- ☐ Post-assessment and feedback form completed before people leave
- ☐ Photos of flipcharts and outputs taken
- ☐ Attendance and results saved for the report
- ☐ Follow-up message with resources sent within 48 hours

The pre/post pair is what makes results reportable. Ask the same 3-5 questions at the start and at the end: the difference is the evidence funders and organisers ask for.

